



An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt,
Gnóthaí Baile agus Imirce
Department of Justice,
Home Affairs and Migration

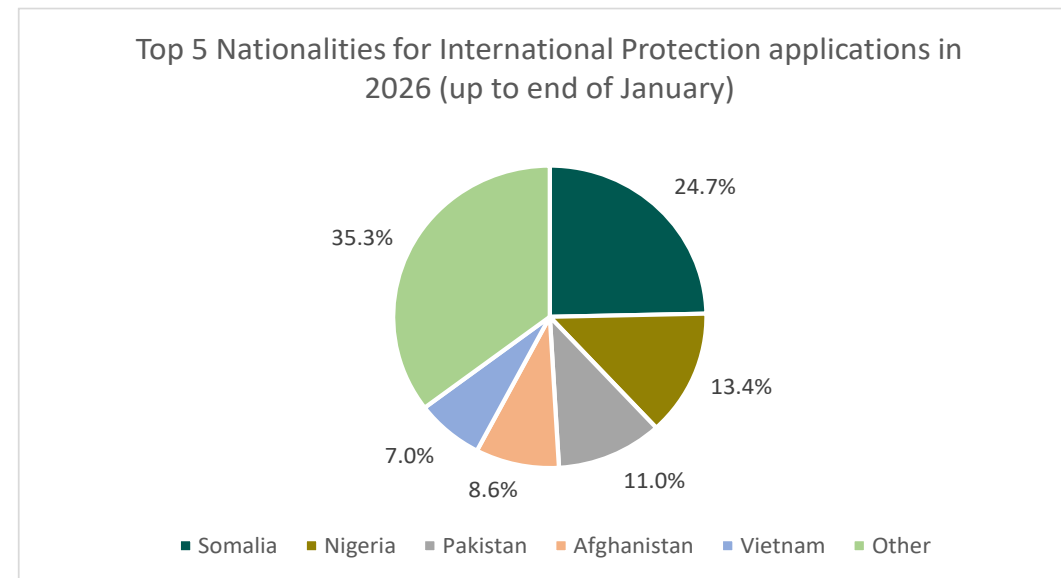
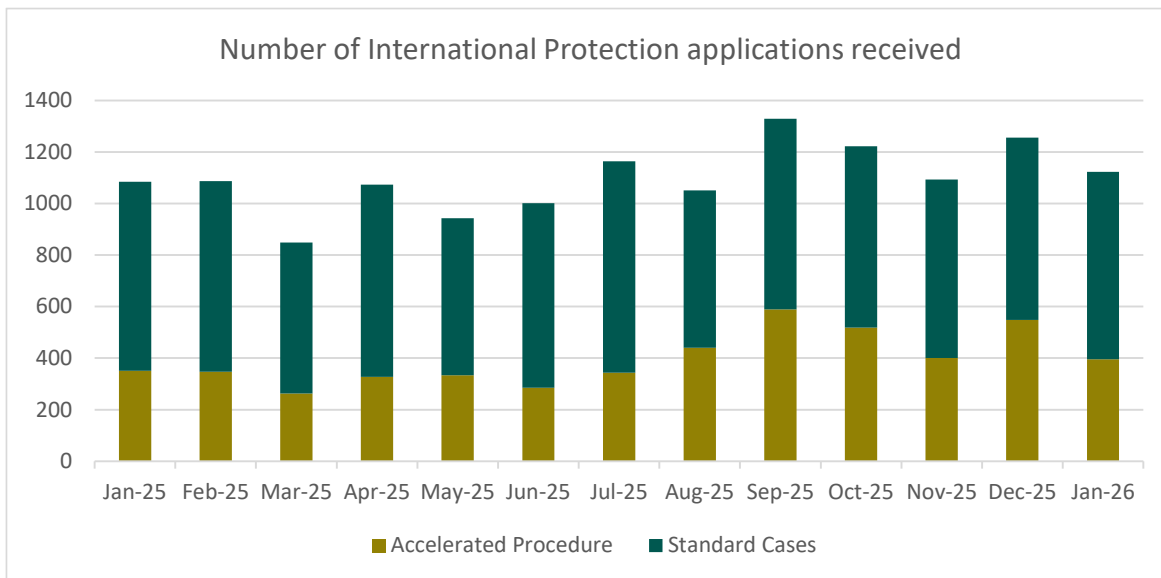
International Protection: January 2026

Executive Summary

The figures in this dashboard were extracted on the 4th February 2026. These are operational figures and subject to change. The charts below refer to key points in the asylum process. A flow chart is provided at the end of the pack that sets out this process. Overall, for January 2026:

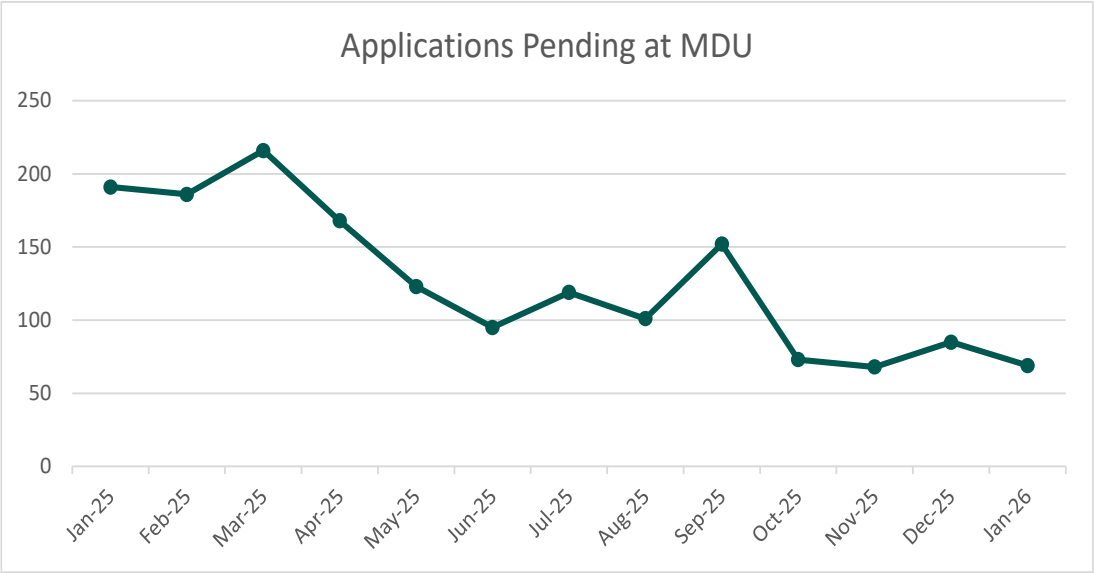
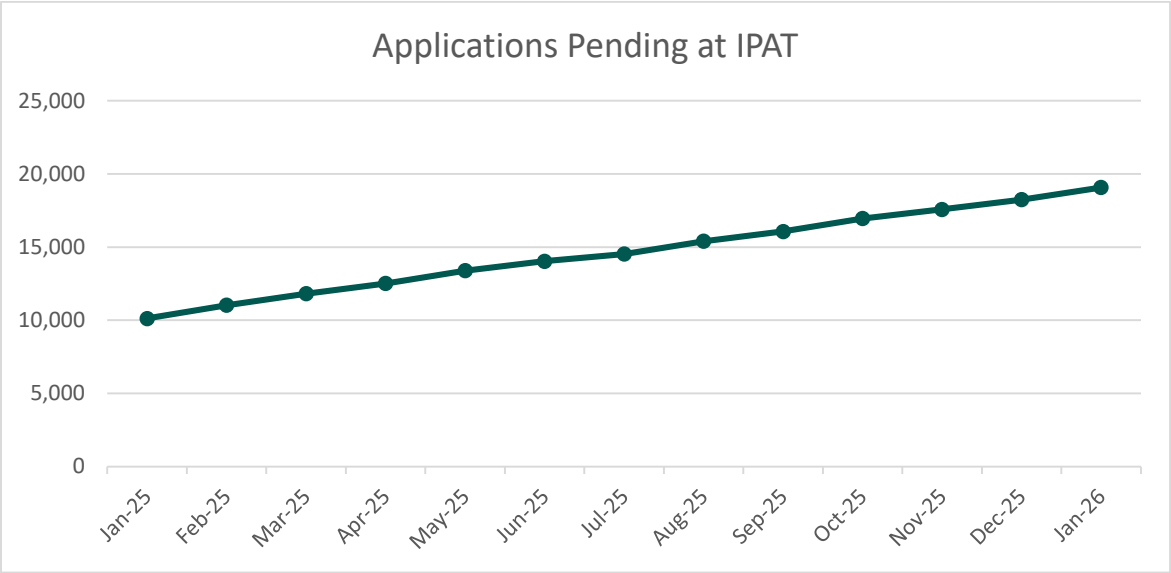
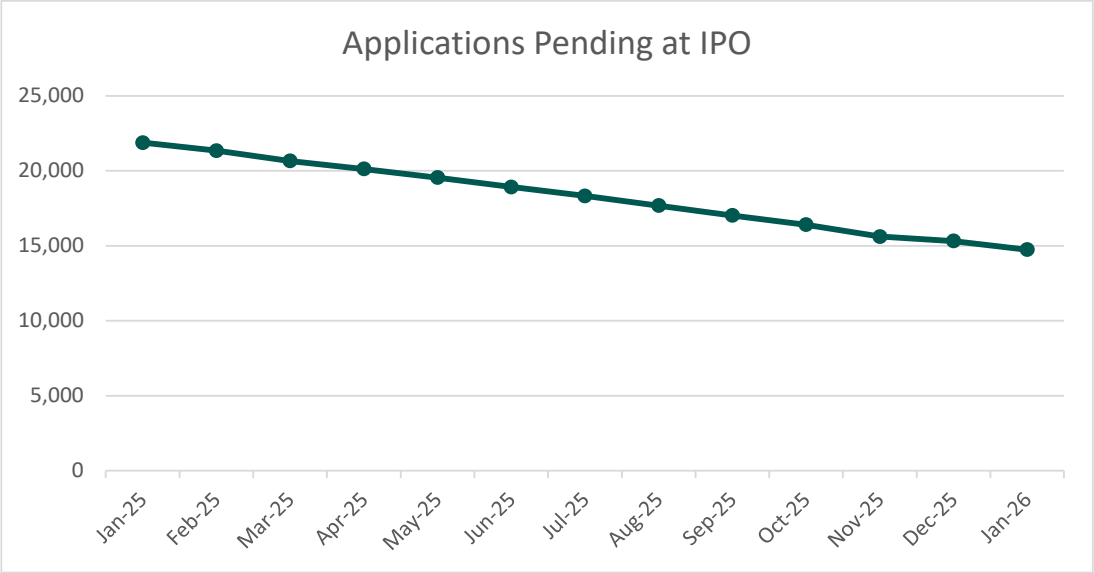
- Compared to last year, the number of asylum applications has risen slightly. In January 2026 there were 1,123 applications compared to 1,085 in January 2025.
- The main countries of origin for 2026 are: Somalia (277 applications), Nigeria (151), Pakistan (123), Afghanistan (97) and Vietnam (79).
- The number of applications pending in the IPO has been reducing since the end of September 2024, when it stood at 23,863. As of January this year, there were 14,741 applications pending
- Compared to last year, there has been an decrease in the number of applications where the IPO made a recommendation or otherwise closed off a case. In January 2026, 1,682 cases were closed off compared to 1,776 in January 2025
- The median time to make a decision for standard cases has been remaining steady in the last three months. In January 2026, the median processing time to determination was 76 weeks (compared to 67 weeks in July 2025 and 76 weeks in October 2025)
- The number of staff in the IPO remains steady at 611 at the end of January 2026
- Of those applications where a final decision was made in January 2026 (for example, after the outcomes of appeals were considered), 59% of decisions were refusals, 2% permission to remain, and 39% were international protection grants

Applications and Main Nationalities



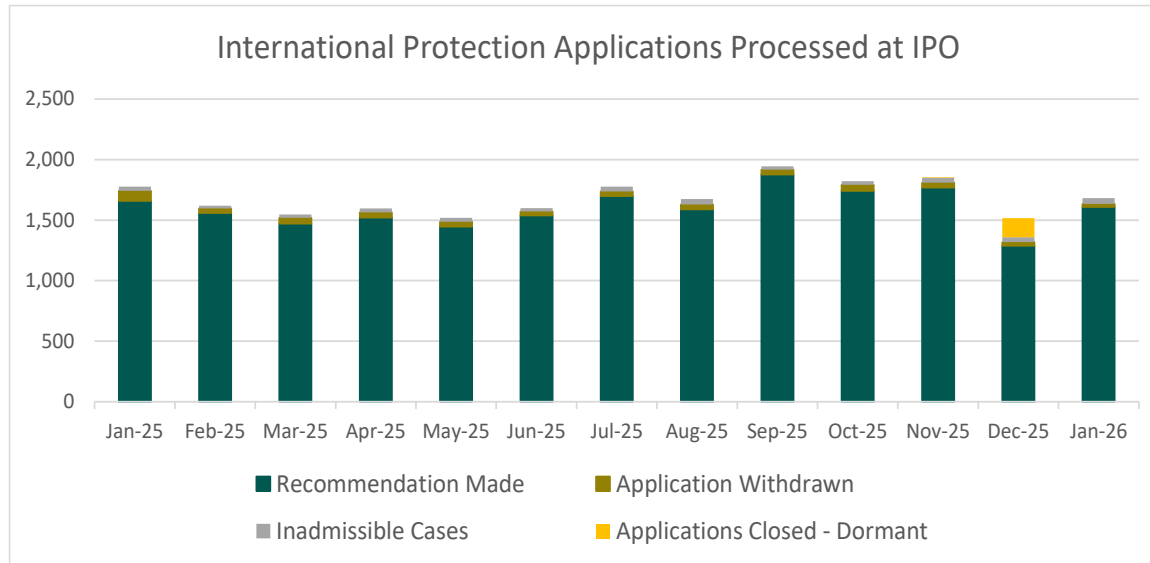
- In January 2026 there were 1,123 applications received for asylum. This is up from 1,085 last January
- The total number of applications in January 2026 that fell under accelerated procedure was 396 (which represents 35% of all applicants)
- The main countries of origin for 2026 are: Somalia (277 applications), Nigeria (151), Pakistan (123), Afghanistan (97) and Vietnam (79)

Pending International Protection Applications

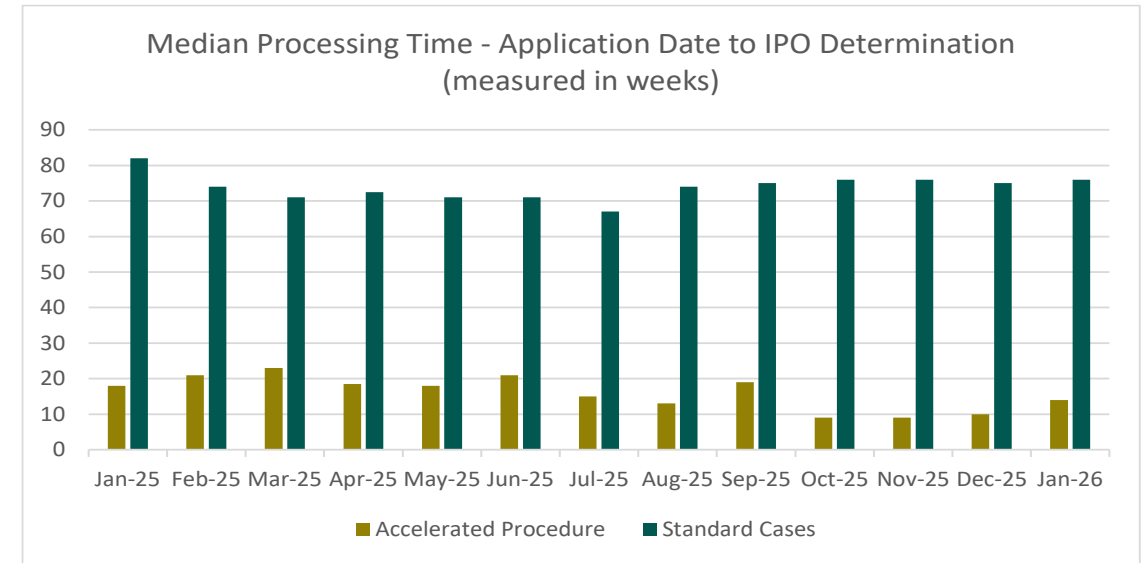


- The number of applications pending in the IPO is 14,741. The numbers have been reducing since the end of September 2024
- The number of pending applications for IPAT has been trending upwards. In January 2026, there were 19,076 applications pending
- The pending figure for MDU at the end of January 2026 is 69

International Protection: Applications Processed and Median Processing Time

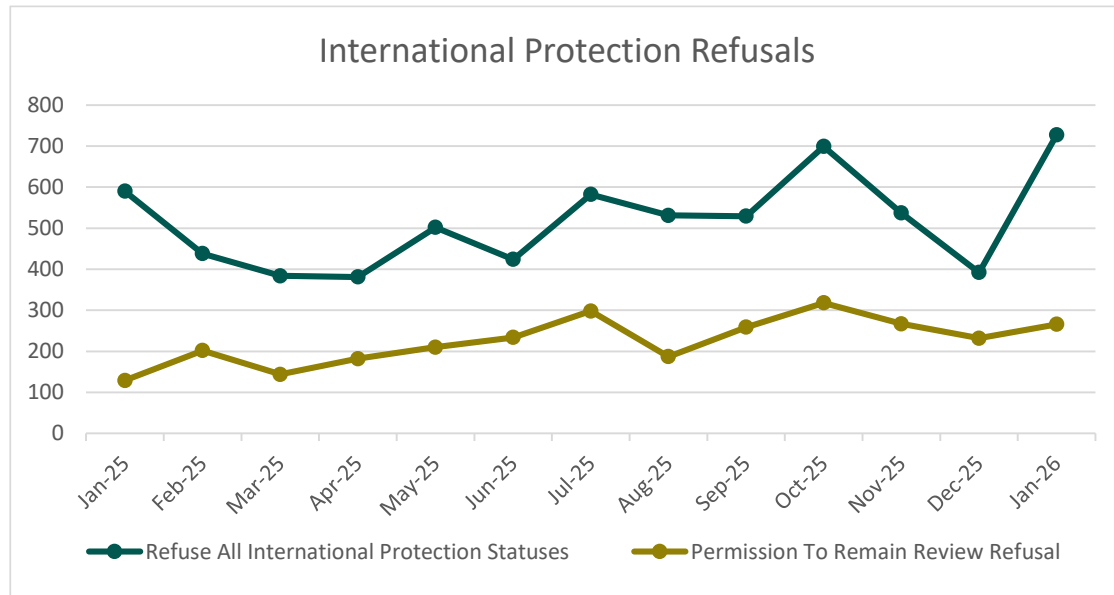
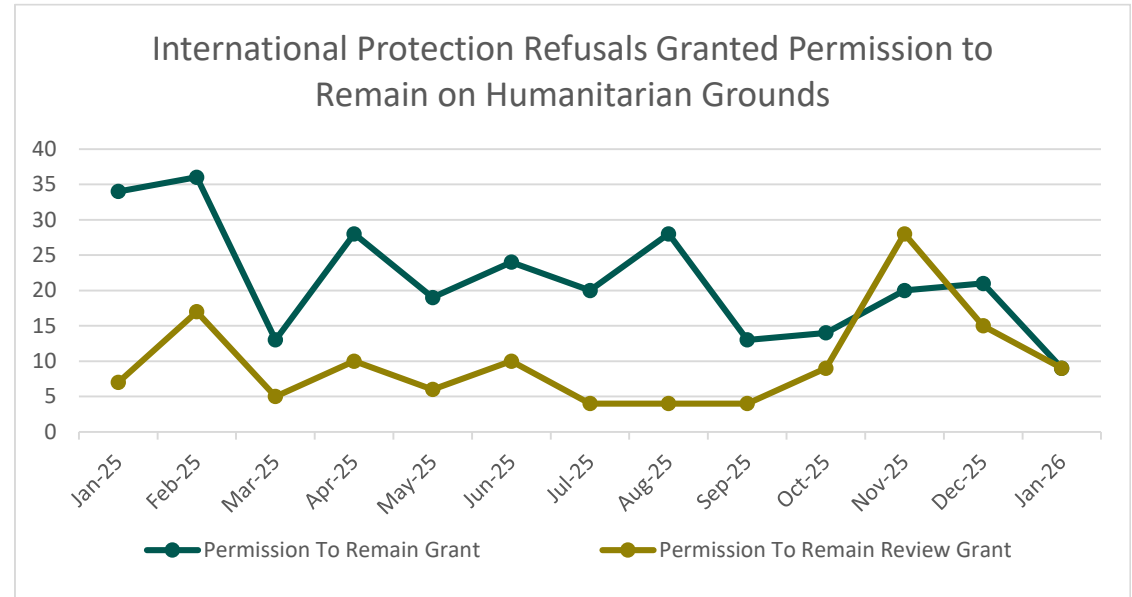
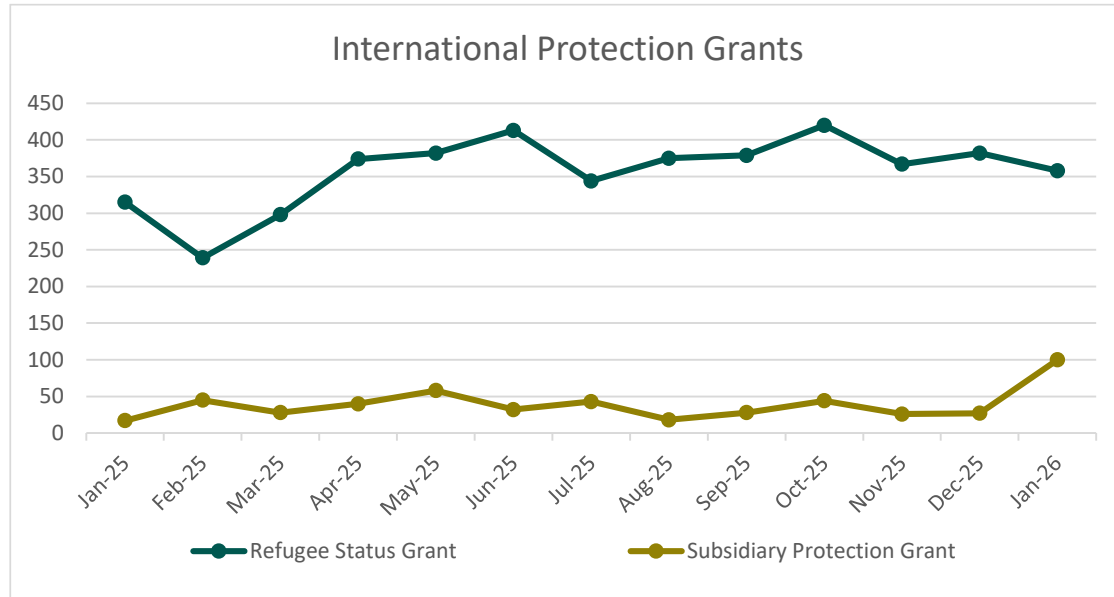


- This table is counting Recommendations Made, Applications Deemed Inadmissible, Applications Withdrawn and Dormant Applications
- In January 2026, 1,682 cases were closed off. This is down from 1,854 in November and up from 1,516 in December 2025
- 2026 YTD applications processed were 1,682 (a 5.3% decrease on 1,776 applications processed for 2025)



- The median processing time to determining an outcome to an asylum application had been remaining steady for Standard Cases. The median processing time for cases under the Accelerated Procedure have decreased compared to the first half of 2025.
- In January 2026, the median processing time to determination for standard cases was 76 weeks (up from 67 weeks in July 2025 and the same as the 76 weeks in October 2025)
- For accelerated procedure only, the median processing time was 14 weeks in January 2026, up from 9 weeks in November 2025 and up from 10 weeks in December 2025

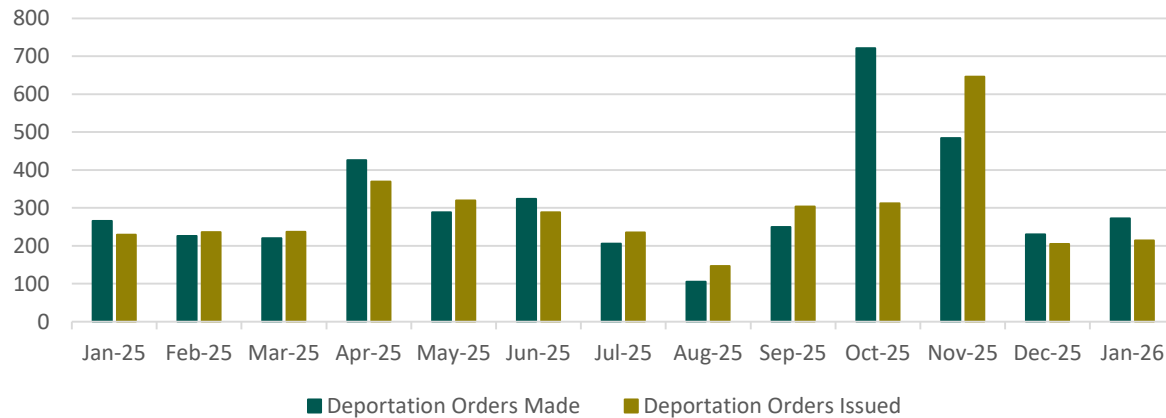
International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused



- In January 2026, of those applications where a final decision was made (for example, after taking into account appeals), 358 were given refugee status grant and 100 subsidiary protection grant (458 in total). There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- Of those who were refused refugee status and subsidiary protection, 9 were given Permission to Remain on humanitarian grounds with 9 on a Permission to Remain Review Grant. There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- There were 727 refusals for International Protection Statuses and 266 for Permission to Remain Review
- Overall, for January 2026, 59% of decisions were refusals, 2% permission to remain, and 39% were international protection grants

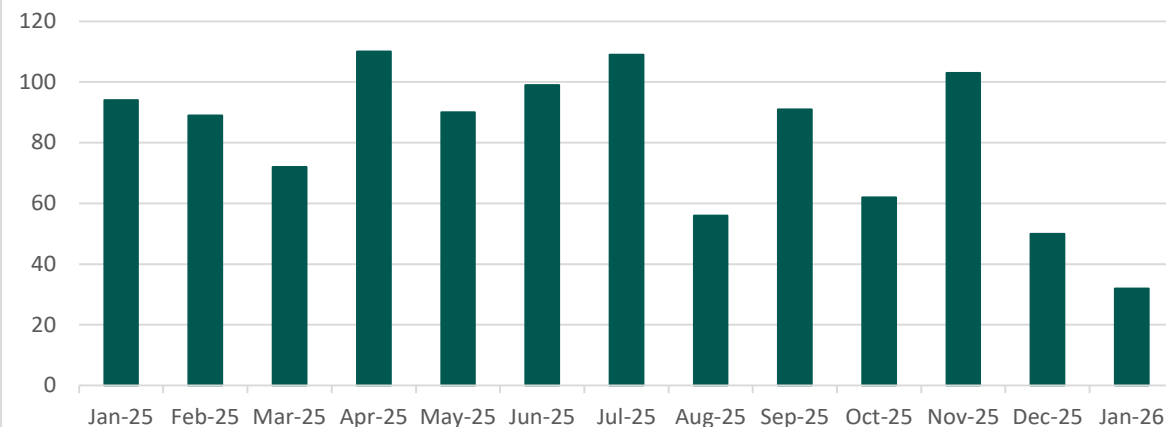
Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

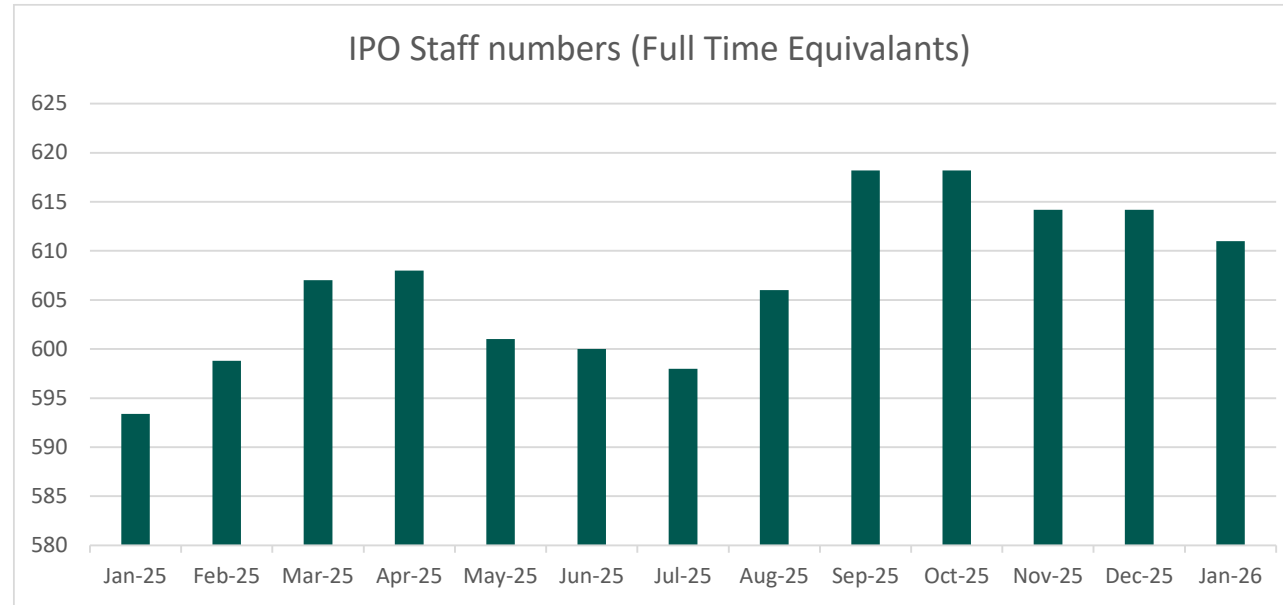


- For January 2026 the number of deportation orders made/signed (where a person had a previous asylum application) was 272 and the number of deportation orders issued was 214. For December 2025, the figures were 230 and 205, and for November 2025, the figures were 484 and 646, respectively
- For January 2026 the number of removals was 32

Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application



IPO Staff number (Full-Time Equivalents)



- The number of staff in the IPO has started levelling off
- In January 2025 there were 593 FTEs in IPO. This number has been slowly trending upwards, to 614 in November and December 2025
- At the end of January 2026, the IPO had 611 FTE staff



Appendix

Methodology

Pending International Protection Applications

- IPO – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- IPAT – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- MDU – Data sourced from AISIP. Pending figure does not include legacy cases – the legacy data has been captured in such a way that it cannot be accurately reported on

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes

International Protection Applications Processing Times

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- Applicants to whom section 38(5) of the International Protection Act 2015 applies (failure to co-operate) are included in the calculations
- Where an interview took place after a case was reactivated the reactivation date is used as the application date, otherwise the original application date was used for the processing time calculation
- The median calculation is used for processing time at IPO as there are significant outliers in the length of time asylum applications can spend in processing. This is typically due to lengthy procedures such as judicial reviews which are complex and time consuming by their nature, and which are also outside of the remit and control of the IPO during that part of the process. The median is a more accurate measure of the time spent by the IPO in processing applications.

Methodology

International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

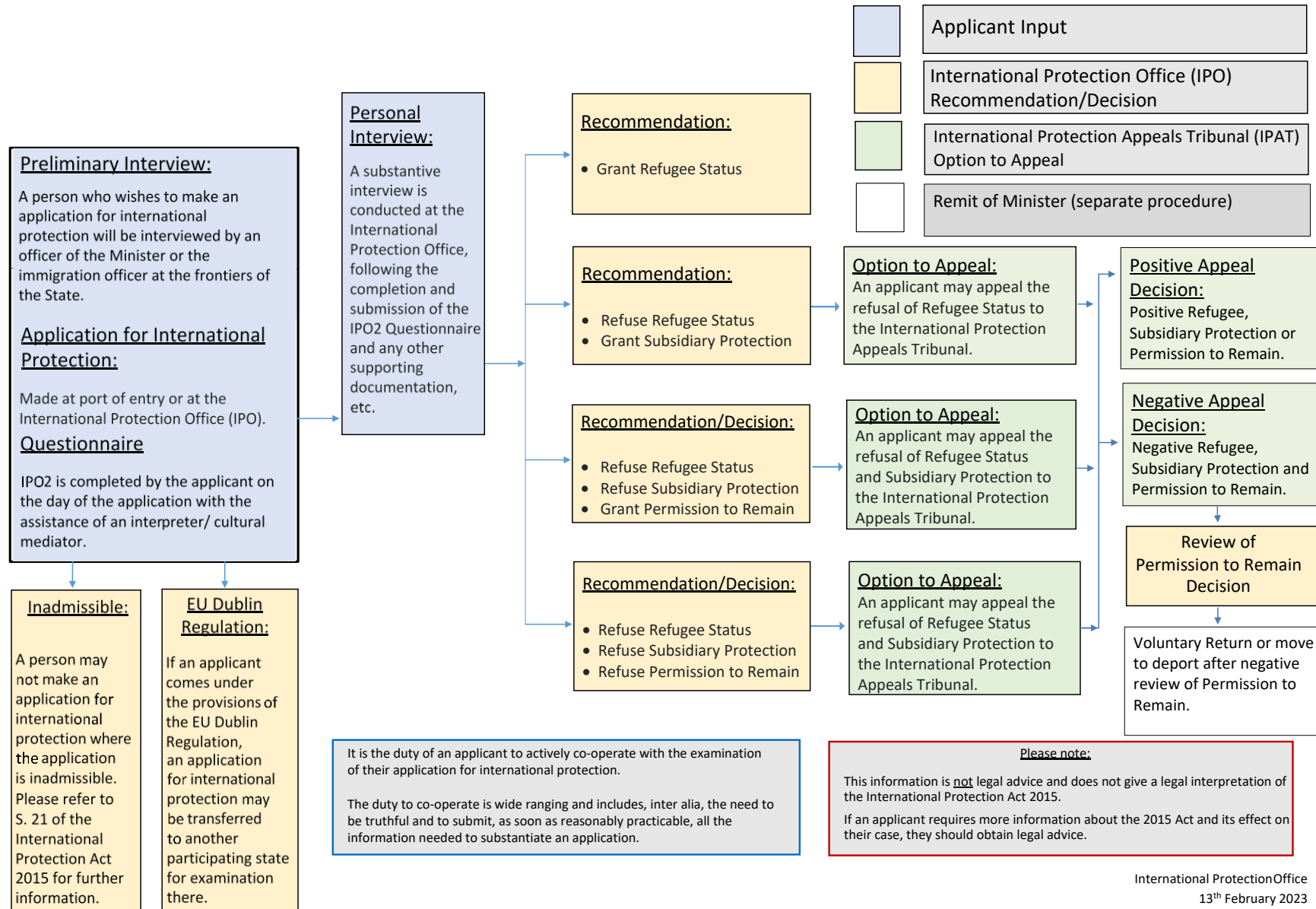
- Quashed decisions and Revocation of Status are not included
- Decision figures include international protection decisions (IPDN) and legacy application types
- Each applicant is represented once in the granted and refused tables
 - For example, if a person is refused refugee status but is granted subsidiary protection they are recorded once in the tables as a subsidiary protection grant. This is to more clearly represent the overall numbers of granted and refused applicants, and to avoid double counting of individuals where they are refused one type of status but are granted another.
- Some of the applicants who have been granted permission to remain are also included in the 'Refuse All International Protection Statuses' category of the refusals table. Permission to remain is a humanitarian permission. In order to be considered for permission to remain you must first have been refused international protection. On slide 7, the 'International Protection Refusals Granted Permission to Remain on Humanitarian Grounds' chart is a combination of applicants still in the asylum process and applicants who have finished the process. The 'International Protection Refusals' chart includes only those applicants who have finished the asylum process.
- Where a revocation occurs the original grant is removed from the figures for the month the permission was originally granted. For example, if an application was granted in January but subsequently revoked later in the year the January figure is updated to remove the grant

Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

- Data for the International Protection Deportation Order (IPDP) application type is sourced from AISIP. All other data is sourced from Lotus Notes

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015



Data Tables (1)

International Protection Office - Applications Received

	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26
Accelerated Procedure	351	347	263	327	333	285	344	440	589	519	400	549	396
Standard Cases	734	741	586	747	610	717	821	611	741	704	694	707	727

International Protection Office – Top 5 Nationality Applications

Top 5 nationalities 2026	Applications	%
Somalia	277	24.7%
Nigeria	151	13.4%
Pakistan	123	11.0%
Afghanistan	97	8.6%
Vietnam	79	7.0%
Other	396	35.3%
Total	1123	

Data Tables (2)

International Protection Office - Pending Applications

	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26
IPO Pending													
IP Pending	21,882	21,343	20,655	20,122	19,551	18,922	18,323	17,676	17,021	16,402	15,620	15,315	14,741
Leg Pending	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

International Protection Appeals Tribunal - Pending Applications

	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26
IPAT Pending	10123	11028	11814	12517	13393	14035	14529	15397	16067	16958	17579	18243	19076

Ministerial Decisions Unit - Pending Applications

	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26
MDU Pending													
Total	191	186	216	168	123	95	119	101	152	73	68	85	69

Data Tables (3)

International Protection Office – Processed Cases

	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26
Recommendation Made	1658	1559	1471	1522	1446	1540	1698	1588	1876	1741	1769	1289	1608
Application Withdrawn	84	38	47	43	41	31	40	40	40	51	41	29	25
Inadmissible Cases	34	23	28	31	31	27	39	46	28	31	40	41	49
Applications Closed - Dormant	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	4	157	0

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to IPO Determination (measured in weeks)

	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26
Accelerated Procedure	18	21	23	18.5	18	21	15	13	19	9	9	10	14
Standard Cases	82	74	71	72.5	71	71	67	74	75	76	76	75	76

Data Tables (4)

International Protection Decisions – Grants

	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26
Refugee Status Grant	315	239	298	374	382	413	344	375	379	420	367	382	358
Subsidiary Protection Grant	17	45	28	40	58	32	43	18	28	44	26	27	100
Permission To Remain Grant	34	36	13	28	19	24	20	28	13	14	20	21	9
Permission To Rrmain Review Grant	7	17	5	10	6	10	4	4	4	9	28	15	9

International Protection Decisions – Refusals

	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26
Refuse All International Protection Statuses	590	438	384	381	502	424	582	531	529	699	537	392	727
Permission To Remain Review Refusal	129	202	144	182	210	234	298	187	259	318	267	232	266

Data Tables (5)

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26
Deportation Orders Made	266	226	220	426	288	324	206	105	250	721	484	230	272
Deportation Orders Issued	229	236	237	369	320	288	235	147	304	312	646	205	214

Deportation Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application

Enforcements/Returns*	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26
Total	94	89	72	110	90	99	109	56	91	62	103	50	32

Data Tables (6)

International Protection Office Staff Numbers (Full-Time Equivalents)

	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26
IPO Staffing Levels	593.4	598.8	607	608	601	600	598	606	618.2	618.2	614.2	614.2	611